WHYDIVE

Parent Framework Institute — whydive.org

operated by Living Spiral Studio LLC, with a flagship revenue application in Chart-Ed (Chart-Ed Learning • Chart-Ed Institute for Global Data Literacy) and a district-facing application in WhyDive Education

Business Overview & Strategic Growth Plan

Prepared for SBA Advisory Consultation

Primary Advisory Need: Marketing Strategy & Go-to-Market Execution

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1. Executive Summary

> *"The world has invested heavily in helping people acquire information. WhyDive exists to help people determine what that information actually justifies them in believing, deciding, and doing."*

Living Spiral Studio LLC is an Atlanta-based, bootstrapped, single-founder education technology company. The company has built a working, deployed, adaptive diagnostic assessment platform for K-12 data literacy — grounded in a published academic standard the founder authored — and has architected a broader, domain-neutral reasoning framework with applications well beyond K-12 education.

The core product and technology are built. Compliance infrastructure (FERPA, data processing agreements, a trust center) is in place at a level unusual for a bootstrapped solo venture. What the company lacks is not capability — it is a proven, resourced go-to-market and marketing engine to convert a genuinely differentiated product into paying customers, recurring revenue, and defensible market position.

This document summarizes the business, its architecture, its current stage of development, and — most importantly — the specific marketing and business-development gaps where outside expertise is being sought. The founder is a 20+ year educator and administrator and a full-stack developer; he is not a trained marketer or salesperson, and this is the single greatest constraint on the company's growth.

> *"The platform is ready. The asset that is missing is not code — it is paying clients."*
> *— Founder self-assessment, strategic advisory session, April 2026*

2. Company Description & Legal Structure

Item	Detail
Legal entity	Living Spiral Studio LLC (Georgia)
Formed	February 2026
Location	Atlanta, Georgia
Ownership	Single founder, 100% owned; fully bootstrapped, no outside capital
DBAs	Chart-Ed Learning • Chart-Ed Institute for Global Data Literacy • (reserved) Living Spiral Education
Parent framework	WhyDive — not yet a separate legal entity; the framework institute site (whydive.org) is live and public
Technology infrastructure	Hostinger VPS managed via Coolify; DNS/CDN via Cloudflare; Stripe for payments
Founder background	20+ years as a classroom educator and school administrator; full-stack developer; author of the published Global Data Literacy Standards (DLS) v1.0.1

A governing distinction, established on whydive.org and treated as fixed for this document: WhyDive is the parent framework and the senior brand. It is not a DBA and not a product — it is the intellectual and architectural home that everything else, including Chart-Ed, sits beneath. Chart-Ed is a flagship application of WhyDive and the company's near-term revenue engine, but it does not supersede WhyDive in positioning, messaging, or public identity. This distinction is the frame for the entire document and should be the frame for any marketing plan built from it.

3. The Problem We Solve

Modern institutions have become extraordinarily good at producing information — schools, businesses, governments, and now AI systems generate more data, dashboards, charts, and recommendations than ever before. Yet poor decisions remain common. The missing capability is not access to information. It is the ability to determine what conclusions the available evidence actually justifies. Today's tools mostly do one of two things: deliver information, or measure whether it was memorized. Almost none explicitly teach people to determine what evidence supports, where inference begins, what remains uncertain, and what would be an overclaim. That is the gap WhyDive is built to fill.

Students at every grade level encounter charts, data, and quantitative claims constantly — on state assessments, across every content area, and in daily life. Yet no K-12 standard existed that defined, in a stepwise developmental way, what it means to actually reason well from a chart rather than simply locate a number on it. The founder identified this gap directly from classroom and administrative experience and authored the Global Data Literacy Standards (DLS) to fill it.

In building an assessment against that standard, the founder discovered a second, larger opportunity: the same underlying reasoning problem — people drawing conclusions that exceed what their evidence actually supports — shows up far beyond chart-reading. It appears in reading comprehension, argumentation, business decision-making, and beyond. This is the origin of WhyDive, the company's parent reasoning framework.

In plain terms, for two audiences:

- Teachers and schools: students can look at a chart but very few can actually read one — understanding what it shows, what it implies, and what it does not prove.
- District leaders: state assessments show what students got wrong, but not how they were reasoning when they got there. This is a diagnostic gap current assessment infrastructure does not fill.

Why this matters now

Three forces are converging to make judgment — not information — the scarce capability: information has become abundant, so finding it is no longer the primary challenge; AI has accelerated content creation, making the ability to evaluate AI-generated claims increasingly critical; and organizations across education, business, healthcare, and government are making higher-stakes decisions from more complex evidence than ever. Demand for stronger judgment is increasing while practical systems for developing it remain limited.

Why customers actually pay

Customers rarely pay for information — they pay for better outcomes. Teachers do not buy Chart-Ed because they lack charts; charts are free. They buy it because they want students who reason more effectively from evidence. Districts will not purchase WhyDive because they need another assessment; they will purchase it because it helps them understand how students reason, in a way traditional assessments cannot. The product being sold is never the chart. The product is stronger judgment.

4. Product & Business Architecture

The ecosystem is organized in four layers, each answering a different question. This hierarchy is not an internal working theory — it is publicly published and live at whydive.org, and it is treated as governing for all business, sales, and marketing material going forward. Understanding it matters because it determines what may and may not be said about how the pieces relate.

Layer	Question it answers	Examples
1. Framework	What are the universal principles?	WhyDive — evidence, reasoning, judgment, decision, and action
2. Services	How is the framework adapted to a professional domain?	Education (current, most mature); future: Business, Policy, AI, Healthcare
3. Applications	What operational systems make the service usable?	WhyDive Education diagnostics; Data Literacy Standards; Chart-Ed Institute stewardship
4. Products	What does a customer actually buy?	Chart-Ed classroom resources, subscriptions, district implementations

Governing entity map (as published at whydive.org/ecosystem)

Living Spiral Studio LLC is the current legal parent and public contact identity. It operates WhyDive, the parent framework. From WhyDive, two parallel paths run — an application path and a standards path. Chart-Ed sits at the end of the standards path. It is real, revenue-generating, and important, but it is downstream of WhyDive, not beside it or above it.

Entity	Position in hierarchy	Site	Role
WhyDive	Parent framework	whydive.org (live)	Domain-neutral framework for evidence, reasoning, judgment, decision, action
WhyDive Education	Application path	whydive.education	District-facing adaptive assessment (Reading + Charts branches)
Data Literacy Standards (DLS)	Standards path	chart-ed.cc/en/standards	Global standards application of WhyDive
Chart-Ed Institute	Standards path — stewardship	chart-ed.cc	Global steward of the DLS
Chart-Ed	Standards path — flagship application	chart-ed.com	American K-12 teacher-facing implementation of the DLS

Distinctions this business must preserve in every external communication

- Chart-Ed is not WhyDive Education — they are different applications on different paths.
- The Data Literacy Standards are not K-12-only, and not the same as Chart-Ed.
- The Chart-Ed Institute is not chart-ed.com.
- WhyDive Education is not subordinate to the DLS or to Chart-Ed.
- WhyDive.org is the framework institute, not a product site — it should never look or read like a Chart-Ed landing page.
- WhyDive is not yet a separate legal company; Living Spiral Studio LLC is the current legal parent.

Strategic note for the advisor: the hierarchy itself is already resolved and published — it is not an open question this engagement needs to re-litigate. The real risk is a sequencing problem, not an architecture problem: Chart-Ed is where the near-term revenue is, which means it is naturally where the founder's time, urgency, and public attention will gravitate by default. Without deliberate marketing discipline, the revenue-generating child (Chart-Ed) can end up more visible, more repeated, and more "branded" in the market than the parent (WhyDive) it depends on — which would misrepresent the business and undercut the long-term asset. The marketing question this engagement should help answer is how to run an aggressive, revenue-first Chart-Ed go-to-market motion in the next 90 days without letting Chart-Ed eclipse WhyDive in the story the market hears.

5. Current Products & Offerings

This section reflects a direct review of the live chart-ed.com store as of July 2026, and corrects pricing and packaging assumptions carried over from earlier internal planning documents.

Offering	Buyer	Price point (live, July 2026)	Status
Chart-Ed digital product packs (Data Ascent, Data Math, Test Prep — Standard & Advanced, Data Forensics)	Individual teachers, homeschoolers	$10.99–$13.99 per product, sold individually per chart/grade variant	Live storefront with 122 products across 14 pages — catalog build is well beyond early-stage
Complete Chart Literacy Unit (bundle)	Individual teachers	Bundle of all four product lines for one chart; 20% savings vs. buying separately	Live
Chart-Ed teacher/school subscription	Individual teachers; schools	Not currently visible on the live store — the storefront is a la carte only	Not confirmed live; earlier internal plans assumed a $9/mo tier that does not currently appear on chart-ed.com
Chart-Ed adaptive assessment platform	Schools / districts (select-classroom entry)	Included in subscription / district package	Fully operational
WhyDive Education district implementation	School districts	$8,000–$18,000+ per district (select-classroom to expansion)	Platform operational; zero contracted districts to date
Data Literacy Standards (DLS v1.0.1)	Free, public standard	Free (drives authority & credibility)	Published, DOI-registered

Two corrections worth flagging directly for the advisor. First, live per-product pricing ($10.99–$13.99) is roughly double the $4.99–$5.99 figure used in earlier internal revenue planning — pricing has moved up since that plan was written, which changes the unit economics in Section 6 below. Second, the live store shows no visible recurring subscription option; the current commercial model is a la carte digital purchases plus a bundle discount, not the $9/mo individual subscription assumed in the original roadmap. If a subscription still exists as a sales-team offer outside the self-serve store, that should be confirmed and reconciled — otherwise the roadmap below should be read as describing a plan, not the live model.

The company also holds legitimate compliance and procurement infrastructure — FERPA-aligned data handling, a data processing agreement, and a public trust center — that is unusually mature for a bootstrapped solo venture and directly supports district sales conversations.

6. Business Model & Revenue Roadmap

Revenue is intentionally sequenced so that each phase generates cash before the next phase requires further investment of time or money. This reflects the bootstrapped, self-funded nature of the business: development is not meant to precede income. The phase targets below are the original planning figures; given the pricing correction above, actual Phase 1–2 dollar targets are likely understated relative to what the live per-product pricing would produce at the same unit volumes, but this has not been recalculated against actual sales data.

Phase	Timeline	Target monthly revenue	Core unlock
1. Digital products	Weeks 1–4	First $200–500	No new code required; worksheet packs & mini-course
2. School subscriptions	Weeks 5–12	$500–$2,000/mo recurring	Question bank + Google Classroom integration
3. Platform launch	Months 4–6	$3,000–$8,000/mo recurring	Full adaptive assessment live at scale
4. Districts + scale	Month 6+	$10,000+/mo	District contracts; investor-ready proof of concept

As of the most recent internal strategic review, the company has zero signed district clients; proof of concept exists on paper (a completed reliability pilot, a fully operational platform) but not yet in the form of paying, referenceable customers. This is the single most important gap the company needs to close, and it is fundamentally a sales-and-marketing gap, not a product gap.

7. Target Market & Customer Segments

Segment	Who	Entry point	Sales motion
Individual teachers	K-12 teachers, homeschool educators (national)	Low-cost digital products, $9/mo subscription	Content marketing, Pinterest, Instagram, Facebook groups, email list
Schools	Principals, instructional coaches (warm network first)	School-level subscription license	Founder's 20-year professional network; direct outreach
School districts	Curriculum directors, assistant superintendents (Georgia-first, national later)	Select-classroom pilot implementation	Direct outreach, RFP/procurement process, district-facing site
Global education field (standards)	Researchers, policymakers, international educators	Free published standard (DLS)	Authority content, citation, thought leadership

Separately, whydive.org already publishes six named public audience entry points (“Spaces”): Educators, Clergy and Faith Leaders, Business Executives, Civic and Community Leaders, Researchers and Policy Thinkers, and AI and

Technology Teams. None of these currently has a product, pricing, or sales motion behind it — they exist as framework-level messaging, not commercial segments. They are listed here because an advisor evaluating market size and focus should know this breadth is already public, not merely aspirational, even though revenue activity remains entirely inside the K-12 education segment above.

8. Competitive Landscape & Differentiation

The most common misreading of this business is comparing it to free chart and data sources. That is the wrong comparison, and it is worth walking an advisor through why — the real comparison is raw information versus the development of judgment. Competition sits in three distinct layers, and Chart-Ed / WhyDive competes seriously in only the third.

Layer	Who	What they provide	Why they are not the real competitor
1. Free data & chart sources	Our World in Data, U.S. Census Bureau, BLS, FRED, World Bank, OECD, UNESCO, NASA	Excellent raw data and charts	Their purpose is to publish data. Our purpose is to develop judgment. They produce the raw material; Chart-Ed teaches students how to reason from it.
2. Education platforms	IXL, i-Ready, Curriculum Associates, NWEA, Newsela, CommonLit	Content mastery, benchmark assessment, reading/math practice	They compete for the same budget and instructional time, but for a different outcome — content mastery, not evidence-based judgment.
3. Direct product competition	Teachers Pay Teachers, teacher blogs, downloadable worksheet packs	Individual chart activities and worksheets	This is real, near-term commercial competition — but these are one-off activities. Chart-Ed provides a developmental reasoning system, not a single resource.

> *The chart is not the product. Judgment is the product.*
> *Charts are simply the evidence through which judgment is developed — and Chart-Ed is the first commercial implementation of that idea. The same framework that develops judgment through charts will extend to reading, writing, business, healthcare, leadership, and AI. The evidence changes; the framework does not.*

9. Competitive Advantages

- A fully operational adaptive assessment platform with state-by-state standards localization — not a prototype.
- A published, DOI-registered K-12 standard (DLS v1.0.1) that gives the product institutional and academic credibility competitors without a standard cannot easily replicate.
- A domain-neutral parent framework (WhyDive) that extends the addressable market well beyond K-12 education into reading, business, and other reasoning-dependent domains.
- District-grade compliance infrastructure (FERPA alignment, data processing agreement, trust center) rarely seen in a bootstrapped solo product — this reduces procurement friction.

- A founder who is a credible peer to the district administrators being sold to, with 20+ years as an educator and administrator.
- A low-friction adoption model: no curriculum adoption required, no replacement of state assessments, a 45-minute diagnostic entry point.

10. Current Status & Honest Constraints

This section is included deliberately, because an SBA advisor can only give useful guidance against an accurate picture of where the business actually stands, not an aspirational one. It reflects a direct review of the live whydive.org site as of July 2026, which has updated several items below since the company's April 2026 internal strategic review.

Component	Status
Adaptive assessment platform	Fully operational and live
Data Literacy Standards (DLS)	Published at v1.0.1
WhyDive reliability / validation pilot	12-case pilot complete; evaluator scoring in progress
Compliance infrastructure (FERPA, DPA, trust center)	In place
Paying district clients	None to date — proof of concept is on paper, not yet in revenue
WhyDive.org (framework anchor site)	Live and public. Built out with Foundations, Spaces, Essays, Whitepapers, Research, Applications, and Ecosystem sections — this is no longer an unbuilt asset.
WhyDive foundational whitepapers	Whitepaper 1 (“Why It Exists”) and Whitepaper 2 (“How It Works”) are published as a public-distribution v1.0 PDF pair, dated June 2026. This closes a gap the founder had previously flagged as unaddressed.
WhyDive domain-application whitepapers (Business, Policy, AI Evaluation, Arguments, Higher Ed)	Scaffolded and listed publicly on whydive.org as “Layer 5: Future Domain Implementations,” but currently only reader-guide placeholder pages — audience and purpose defined, full essay content not yet written.
Public audience segmentation (“Spaces”)	Live: whydive.org already publishes six named audience entry points — Educators, Clergy and Faith Leaders, Business Executives, Civic and Community Leaders, Researchers and Policy Thinkers, and AI and Technology Teams — well beyond the K-12 focus the company currently sells into.
Marketing / sales infrastructure	Minimal; founder has no formal marketing or sales background
Working capital	None significant; fully self-funded by founder's time and labor

The founder has also explicitly named a real risk: development fatigue — a tendency, common among technical solo founders, to keep building product instead of selling what already exists. The business does not currently have a capacity or workflow gap in engineering. It has a capacity and expertise gap in marketing, sales, and go-to-market execution.

A new tension surfaces directly from this review: the public-facing framework site now speaks to six broad professional audiences (education, faith, business, civic life, research/policy, and AI/technology) before the company has proof of paying customers in any one of them, let alone the primary one. This is not a defect — the framework genuinely is that broad — but it raises the stakes on the sequencing guidance requested in Section 11.2 below: whydive.org can keep speaking to all six audiences as a matter of intellectual honesty, while sales and marketing effort stays deliberately narrow.

11. Where This Business Needs a Marketing Expert

This is the core purpose of this document. The founder is seeking an SBA advisor's help specifically in the areas below — not general encouragement, but concrete strategic and tactical guidance from someone with real marketing and go-to-market expertise.

11.1 Positioning & message simplification

The underlying framework (WhyDive) is intellectually sophisticated and multi-layered. A district administrator making a budget decision needs one clear sentence, not an architecture diagram. The business needs help distilling a genuinely complex, multi-brand system into a single, sharp, repeatable pitch for each audience — teachers, principals, and district leaders — without losing what makes the offering differentiated.

11.2 Go-to-market sequencing

With four active brand faces (WhyDive, WhyDive Education, Chart-Ed Institute, Chart-Ed Learning) and — as confirmed by a direct review of whydive.org — six additional publicly named audience segments beyond education (faith leaders, business executives, civic leaders, researchers/policy thinkers, AI/technology teams), the founder needs help deciding which single offer and audience to lead with commercially right now, in what order to bring the others forward, and how to avoid diluting a solo founder's limited time across too many simultaneous go-to-market motions. The framework site can legitimately keep speaking to all of these audiences; sales effort should not.

11.3 District / B2B sales strategy

The highest-value revenue opportunity (district contracts, $8,000–$18,000+ each) is also the least developed from a sales-process standpoint: no target district list has been built, no outreach sequence has been tested, and no pricing communication strategy has been finalized. This is classic sales-and-marketing-process work — building a qualified pipeline, an outreach cadence, and objection handling — that is outside the founder's expertise.

11.4 Low-cost, high-leverage marketing for a solo founder

On the consumer/teacher side, the company needs a realistic, sustainable content and acquisition system that a single founder can execute (content marketing, email list building, teacher communities, referral mechanics) without burning out or requiring a team the business cannot yet afford.

11.5 Proof-of-concept and social proof strategy

With zero signed districts and no published case studies or testimonials, the company faces the classic “first customer” problem. The founder needs help designing a founding-customer or pilot-partner offer structure that reduces first-adopter risk enough to generate the initial proof points that later sales and marketing depend on.

11.6 Protecting the WhyDive/Chart-Ed hierarchy in execution

The brand hierarchy itself is already settled and published (whydive.org/ecosystem): WhyDive is the parent framework and senior brand; Chart-Ed is a flagship, revenue-generating application beneath it. The open marketing question is not whether to redesign this architecture — it is how to keep it intact once real sales pressure hits. Chart-Ed will generate the founder's first revenue and will consume the most day-to-day attention; left unmanaged, that imbalance can cause Chart-Ed to become the de facto public identity of the company by sheer repetition, while WhyDive quietly becomes an afterthought. The advisor's help is needed on concrete guardrails: how founder bios, email signatures, social profiles, and sales collateral should reference WhyDive even while the pitch itself leads with Chart-Ed.

11.7 Budget-appropriate marketing plan

The business is fully bootstrapped with no significant working capital. Any marketing plan produced needs to assume a near-zero paid budget in the near term, prioritizing time-intensive but low-cost tactics, with a clear articulation of what becomes possible (paid acquisition, sales hires, agency support) once specific revenue milestones are hit.

12. Founder Background

Elvis Agard is the founder of Living Spiral Studio LLC. He has spent 20+ years as a classroom educator and school administrator and is also a full-stack developer, having personally designed and built the company's technology infrastructure. He authored the Global Data Literacy Standards (DLS v1.0.1), published and DOI-registered through the Chart-Ed Institute for Global Data Literacy. His professional network within K-12 education is a genuine, underused asset for early customer acquisition at the school level.

His stated gap, in his own words, is marketing and sales execution — not subject-matter expertise, not product development, and not domain credibility.

13. Specific Requests for This Advisory Engagement

1. Review Sections 4 and 11.6, and recommend concrete guardrails that keep Chart-Ed's revenue-first go-to-market motion from overshadowing WhyDive as the parent brand, without slowing down Chart-Ed sales.
2. Help build a realistic, low-budget marketing plan for the next 90 days that a solo founder can actually execute, prioritized by revenue impact (see Phase 1–2 in Section 6).
3. Help design a district outreach and B2B sales process for the highest-value opportunity (Section 11.3), including a target list approach, outreach cadence, and a founding-district / pilot-partner offer.
4. Advise on pricing communication strategy — specifically whether and how to surface pricing publicly for district and school buyers, and help reconcile the live chart-ed.com store pricing (Section 5) against the original revenue roadmap (Section 6) now that they visibly diverge.
5. Pressure-test the competitive framing in Section 8 (“judgment, not the chart, is the product”) against how a skeptical district buyer or lender will actually hear it, and sharpen it if needed.
6. Identify what SBA resources, counseling programs, or connections (e.g., SCORE mentors, local SBDC marketing specialists, export or grant programs relevant to an ed-tech/publishing business) would most directly address these gaps.

Prepared by Elvis Agard, Founder, Living Spiral Studio LLC — Atlanta, Georgia — July 2026